



Facebook population

Every fourth visitor to Facebook comes from Asia, says O'Reilly Research

Nanopillars in solar cells

University of California researchers have devised nano pillars that can be used to improve solar cells and displays

6 Cops 'n' robbers

The afore-mentioned biometric unique identification could also help reduce crime, and speed up the time it takes to solve cases. Although getting a DNA profile of 1.2 billion people may not be very feasible, biometrics can surely help reel in the crime rate. Face detection is the



most promising of all the crowd-spotting techniques, and perhaps Aadhaar should also include a photograph of everyone – not too much of an ask in terms of storage, but a huge ask when you're counting and identifying a modest 600 million people (UIDAI's target is half our population).

Solution: Aadhaar

Well, why mess with the name the UIDAI has already come up with? The only difference is that we're increasing the scope of the "foundation", and taking it further than the government's initial plan of Aadhaar being a foundation for the Public Distribution System.

Let's get this straight out in the open. You're either going to hate this idea, or not really care. Very few, if any are



going to love the idea. After all, in the digital age, where we're all paranoid about our "privacy", who wants to be catalogued along with 600 million others? What if they mix-up your biometrics with another person with the same name, who happens to have a criminal record? That's where the demographics come in. Your Aadhaar will also contain your date of birth, place of birth and parent's names – which is standard fare for any form you fill in these days anyway – so if you happen to have a doppelganger with the same name, same date of birth, lives in the same city, and has parents with the same names and yours, tough luck, and we're sorry our system failed you. Hope you like jail food.

Seriously though, it would be easy to fix such an error if it occurred. Wait! Allow us to rephrase that. It would be easy for you to prove that an error has been made, how long it would take to fix is anybody's guess. The cynicism of that last sentence stems from numerous visits to government offices for routine paperwork that involved more running-around than we'd normally do in a gym!

How it could work

Thanks to Aadhaar and Cumulo-Indus, what you do and where you go is automatically logged into a system somewhere. Before you conspiracy theorists jump up and down screaming bloody murder, you need to realise that this is not such a big deal. Not until you commit a crime, that is. For example, if you suddenly decide to go on a mass killing spree, murdering people in a mad frenzy on a path from Delhi to Mumbai, a quick Aadhaar search would be able to narrow down the list of suspects who have travelled from Delhi to Mumbai on the exact same path as you to about, oh, 20,000? We are a populous country after all. But then tracking the victim's whereabouts and matching that to the 20K suspects will probably narrow that right down to just you.

The ordinary

Of course it's not all about catching bad guys. If a terrorist attack were

to occur on a train. A quick search could release a list of names of people on the train at the time. If you were on the train, and injured, a quick call to the concerned authorities would allow them to tell your family exactly which hospital you had been taken to, and perhaps even the extent of your injuries, if that were logged by the concerned authorities at the time.

Even petty crime could be traced a lot quicker by lifting prints, or using CCTV footage and face recognition.

The extraordinary

The biometric aspect would make it a lot easier for complaints to be registered. Kiosks outside police stations or public places could register even simple complaints about losing your Me-Mo/Babel-babble phone, or your wallet. If you were pick-pocketed, you could walk over to a kiosk and report it, quickly



give a rough description of the thief, and a police control centre could swing into action, checking CCTV feeds, first locating you, then the pick-pocket, and then ultimately tracking him down to the place he is at the moment, or when he makes the next transaction.

Must-clicks

<http://bit.ly/dAyLHk> | <http://bit.ly/9LrL65> | <http://bit.ly/crHAXD>